

To
The Cabinet Office
Honours Secretariat
10 South Colonnade, 6th Floor,
Canary Wharf
London
E14 4PU

Dated: 11/05/2026

Re: Letter of Support for Dr Dhiraj Gupta

As a consultant cardiologist at Wrightington, Wigan and Leigh Teaching Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust, where I also serve as clinical director and research lead for the medical division, I wholeheartedly support Professor Dr Dhiraj Gupta's nomination for the King's honours.

Professor Gupta is widely regarded as a world authority in cardiac electrophysiology, particularly in the management of atrial fibrillation (AF). He routinely receives complex patients from across the region and beyond. I recall referring a patient to Professor Gupta after several unsuccessful ablation procedures in Manchester. The patient returned from Liverpool after undergoing a successful ablation procedure under his care and has since maintained an active and healthy lifestyle for over five years. Many similar patients in the North-West have benefited from Professor Gupta's expertise.

Some patients with AF are unable to take oral anticoagulants due to severe bleeding issues, which pose a high risk of stroke. For several years, there were no viable options for these complex patients. From 2014 onwards, Professor Gupta pioneered the Left Atrial Appendage Occlusion (LAAO) implant procedure to mitigate stroke risk for these patients. As the lead for the regional LAAO service at Liverpool, Professor Gupta performs these implants for patients from the entire North West of England, including Manchester and Blackpool. Over the past few years, Professor Gupta has also undertaken LAAO implants at Royal Victoria Hospital Blackpool, enabling these often elderly patients to access this treatment closer to their homes rather than having to travel to Liverpool.

Prior to Professor Gupta's appointment at Liverpool in 2007, cardiac electrophysiology was regarded as an obscure subspecialty and did not garner significant interest among cardiology trainees. Professor Gupta's unwavering commitment to teaching and training led him to establish and chair the North West AF course, which successfully demystified cardiac electrophysiology for general cardiologists and trainees alike. Consequently, cardiac electrophysiology has become one of the most sought-after and coveted subspecialties within the field of cardiology. Historically, individuals from backgrounds belonging to the BAME backgrounds have been underrepresented in cardiac electrophysiology. Since 2012, Professor Gupta has assumed the role of Fellowship and Training Lead for cardiac electrophysiology at Liverpool and has actively mentored

numerous BAME trainees in this area. He has arranged funded fellowships to trainees from India, Sri Lanka, and Egypt, who are now successfully practicing EP in their respective countries.

I trust that the awards committee will acknowledge Professor Gupta's sustained excellence over the past two decades and his remarkable contributions that have far exceeded the expectations of the medical community. He continues to advocate for British academic medicine on the global stage, while simultaneously maintaining his primary role as a paragon of clinical expertise. Cardiologist colleagues, trainees, and general practitioners alike can rely on Professor Gupta for guidance and advice at any time. His contributions making him a deserving recipient of the King's Honours.

Yours sincerely



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